

distraction free highly valuable

Deep Work by Cal Newport

1. You must master the art of quickly learning complicated things.
2. Deep Work Hypothesis : The ability to perform deep work is becoming increasingly rare at exactly at the same time its becoming valuable in our economy. As a consequence, the few who cultivate this skill, and then make it the core of their working life, will inevitably thrive.
3. Two core abilities for thriving in New economy :
 - a) The ability to quickly master hard things.
 - b) The ability to produce at an elite level, in terms of both quality & speed.
4. Winners in new economy : those who can work creatively with intelligent machines & those who are stars in their fields.
5. Three types of new economy will have a particular advantage : those who can work well & creatively with intelligent machines, those who are best at what they do, & those with access to capital.
6. Tech changes rapidly → process of mastering hard things never ends : you must be able to do it quickly, again & again. If you can't learn, you can't thrive.

Using mind like a lens to focus rays of attention.

7. "Let your mind become a lens, thanks to the converging rays of attention: let your soul be all intent on whatever it is that is established in your mind as a dominant, whetting absorbing idea."
8. Deliberate practice cannot exist alongside distraction, & that it instead requires uninterrupted concentration.
9. To grant, its imp to enforce strict isolation until he completes the task at hand.
10.
$$\text{High Quality Work Produced} = (\text{Time spent}) \times (\text{Intensity of focus})$$
11. Quick check $\rightarrow$ introduces a new target for your attention.
12. So I invented another myth for myself: that I'm irresponsible
13. Our brains $\rightarrow$ construct our world view based on what we pay attention to. "Who you are, what you think, feel & do, what you love - is sum of what you focus on"
14. Your world is outcome of what you pay attention to.
15. If u spend enough time in deep work state, your mind'll understand your world as rich in meaning & importance

Flow generates happiness.

16. 'The idle mind is the devil's workshop...' when you lose focus your mind tends to fix on what could be wrong with your life instead of what's right

17. Neurological perspective → work, ^{day} driven by shallow is likely to be draining & upsetting day even if the things which captured your attention were fun.

18. "I'll choose my targets with care... then give 'em my rapt attention. I'll live the focused life, bcz its the best there is".

19. "The best moments usually occurs when a person's body or mind is stretched to its limits in a voluntary effort to accomplish something difficult & worthwhile."

20. Most people assume that relaxation makes 'em happy we want to work less & spend more time in the hammock.

21. The more flow experiences that occur in a given week, the higher the subjects life satisfaction. Humans are at their best when immersed deeply in something challenging.

22. ^{is} feeling of going deep, in itself very rewarding. Our mind likes this challenge, regardless of the subject.

23. Deep work chamber → allow for total focus & uninterrupted work flow.

24. Main obstacle to going deep: the urge to turn your attention to words something more artificial.

35. You have a finite amt of willpower that depletes as you use it (like a muscle → trained) but also gets tired). These distractions drain finite pool of willpower.
36. Smart routines & rituals → key to develop deep work habit. Just try to make DW a priority.
37. Intellectual elite live in monastic orders, isolated from the distracted masses & tech, thinking deep thoughts.
38. Jung would lock himself every morning into a minimally appointed room to write w/o interruption. He would then meditate & walk in the woods to clarify his thinking in preparation for next days writing.
39. Take a period of 2-4 days to become completely monastic.
40. He keeps a calendar in his wall, everyday marks X (cross day out). "after a few days you'll have a chain". Just keep at it & the chain will grow longer every day. You'll like seeing that chain especially when you get a few weeks under your belt. Your only job is to not break the chain.
41. "The work never seemed to faze him, he just happily went up when he had the spare time." Any time he could find some free time, he would switch into deep work mode & hammer away his book.
42. "I trained myself to be organized".

isolated Deep thinking

43. Great creative mind thinks like an artist but work like accountants.

42. Best advice when trying to do creative work: is to ignore inspiration.

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42. Regardless of where you work, be sure to give yourself a specific time frame to keep the session a definite challenge & not an open ended slog.

43. Your ritual needs rules & processes to keep your efforts structured.

46. "It is only ideas gained from walking that have any worth".

47. Distraction remains a destroyer of depth.

48. Discipline #1: focus on the wildly important.
The more you try to do, the less you actually accomplish.

Discipline #2: Act on the Lead Measures.

#3: Keep a compelling score board.

49. Idleness → brain's vitamin D → paradoxically necessary to getting any work done.

50. Shut down work thinking completely, value a downtime.

51. Some decisions are better left to your unconscious mind to untangle.

focused life >>>

52. Attention Restoration Theory (ART) claims spending time in nature can improve your ability to concentrate.
53. To concentrate requires directed attention: this resource is finite: if you exhaust it you'll struggle to concentrate.
54. Having casual convo with friend, listening to music while making dinner, playing game, going for run, playing on some attention restoring task as walking in the nature.
55. A strict shutdown Ritual
56. When you work, work hard, when you're done, be done.
57. Reality: the ability to concentrate intensely is a skill that must be trained.
58. Athletes must take care of their bodies outside training session, you'll struggle to achieve the deepest level of concentration if you spit most of your time fleeing from boredom. Embrace it.
59. Constant attention switching online has a lasting -ve effect on brain.
60. Once you are wired for distraction, you crave it.
61. "I refined my ability to work deeply".

const switching → weakens mental muscles.

62. The use of a distracting service does not, by itself reduce your brain's ability to focus. It's instead the constant switching from low stimuli / high vol switch at the slightest hint of boredom that teaches your mind to never tolerate an absence of novelty.

63. To succeed with deep work you must train your brain to be comfortable resisting distracting stimuli.

64. "The amt of time he spent at his desk was comparatively small but his concentration was so intense, & his reading so rapid that he could afford more time off than most".

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65. Give yourself a hard deadline that drastically reduces this time. If possible, commit publicly to the deadline.

66. Work with great intensity: attack the task with full force until it gives way under your unwavering barrage of concentration.

67. Biggest diff b/w memory athletes & normal is in a cognitive ability that's not a direct measure of memory at all but of attention.
"ATTENTIONAL CONTROL."

68. Your ability to concentrate is only as strong as your commitment to train it.

Quantify the depth of every activity.

77. Deep work habit requires you to treat your time with respect. Advice: decide in adv. with what you're going to do with every min of your ^{work} day.

78. Commitment fixed-schedule productivity → I don't work after 5.30.
↳ meta habit → back tracks.

79. Become Hard to Reach

80. People appreciate clarity. Most are okay. He not receive a response if they don't expect one.

81. Less mental clutter means more mental resources available for Deep thinking.

82. Don't Respond: famous academics default behavior.

83. It's sender's responsibility to convince the receiver that a reply is worth while.

84. "Develop the habit of letting small bad things happen. If you don't, you'll never find time for the life changing big things."

85. Respect your time & respect your attention.

86. Gates worked with such intensity for such long during 2 months stretch that he'd often collapse into sleep on his keyboard in middle of writing code. He would then sleep for hr/2, wakeup & pick up right where he left off.

Grady obsessive focus!

87. "I created a plan to ~~block~~ my deep work moments."

9 become a sleep walk machine.

88. Ability to concentrate is a skill that gets valuable things done. Deep work enabled to start a billion dollar industry in less than a semester.

89. Deep work is way powerful than most people understand.

90. To leave the distracted masses to join the focused few is a transformative experience. It requires hardwork & drastic change to your habit.

"The one of the most valuable skills in our economy is becoming increasingly rare."

Part 1 : The idea -

- ① Deep work is valuable
- ② Deep work is Rare
- ③ Deep work is Meaningful

Part 2 : The rules :-

Rule ① Work Deeply

Rule # 2 Embrace boredom

Rule # 3 Quit Social Media

Rule # 4 Drain the Shallow.